

Smith's Hill High School

2019 Semester One Report - Year Twelve



Anna STEPHENSON



Smith's Hill High School is an academically selective high school which provides opportunities for student involvement in a wide range of academic, social and extracurricular activities. Our school reports on Anna's progress with written reports twice a year and provides ongoing detail through interviews or meetings.

This report provides you with written information that clearly shows the achievement of Anna compared to her cohort in the courses studied. The marks and outcomes in this report reflect her achievement in these courses so far. The information of this report should be considered in the context of the discussion held with her teachers at the parent teacher night. If you wish, please contact the school to discuss her report and participate in the learning and progress of Anna with the relevant staff members.

Mr David Deitz
Principal

School Activities

Attendance

Explained Whole Days Absent	2	Unexplained Whole Days Absent	0
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Subjects

Mathematics - HSC	Mr D Jones
Mathematics Extension 1 - HSC	Mr D Jones
Physics Stage 6	Mr A Smith
Software Design and Development - HSC	Mr J Taylor
Japanese Continuers - HSC	Ms M MATSUI
English Advanced Stage 6	Ms C Tolland
Modern History Stage 6	Mrs A Heka

Assessment and Performance Descriptions

This report includes a cumulative rank that is derived from the addition of weighted assessments as outlined in subject assessment outlines. This is an indication of a students' rank at the point of the report. It should be noted that later tasks generally have greater weighting than tasks completed early in the program and, as a consequence, rankings may change with subsequent assessment tasks.

A - Outstanding:	The student demonstrates extensive knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies highly developed skills and processes in a wide variety of contexts. In addition the student demonstrates creative and critical thinking skills using perceptive analysis and evaluation. The student effectively communicates complex ideas and information.
B - High:	The student demonstrates thorough knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies well-developed skills and processes in a variety of contexts. In addition the student demonstrates creative and critical thinking skills using analysis and evaluation. The student clearly communicates complex ideas and information.
C - Sound:	The student demonstrates sound knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies skills and processes in a range of familiar contexts. In addition the student demonstrates skills in selecting and integrating information and communicates relevant ideas in an appropriate manner.
D - Basic:	The student demonstrates a basic knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies skills and processes in some familiar contexts. In addition the student demonstrates skills in selecting and using information and communicates ideas in a descriptive manner.
E - Limited:	The student demonstrates an elementary knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies some skills and processes with guidance. In addition the student demonstrates elementary skills in recounting information and communicating ideas.



Mathematics - HSC

In this semester students have engaged in activities that foster an appreciation of the scope, usefulness, beauty and elegance of mathematics. Students have developed their ability to reason in a broad range of mathematical contexts, use skills in applying mathematical techniques to the solution of practical problems, understand the key concepts of calculus and differentiate and integrate a range of functions, and interpret and communicate mathematics in a variety of forms.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

28/89

Mathematics - HSC	A	B	C	D	E
Manipulates algebraic expressions involving logarithmic and exponential functions	✓				
Expresses practical problems in mathematical terms based on simple given models	✓				
Applies appropriate techniques from the study of calculus, geometry, probability, trigonometry and series to solve problems	✓				
Uses the derivative to determine the features of the graph of a function	✓				
Uses the features of a graph to deduce information about the derivative	✓				
Uses techniques of integration to calculate areas and volumes	✓				

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

C = Consistently, U = Usually, S = Sometimes

Teacher Comment

As Mathematics is taught in conjunction with the Mathematics Extension 1 course, please refer to the Mathematics Extension 1 report for comments regarding both courses.

Teacher: Mr D Jones

Class: 12MATA1B



Mathematics Extension 1 - HSC

In this semester students have engaged in activities that foster an appreciation of the scope, usefulness, beauty and elegance of mathematics. Students have developed their ability to reason in a broad range of mathematical contexts, use skills in applying mathematical techniques to the solution of practical problems, understand the key concepts of calculus and differentiate and integrate a range of functions, and interpret and communicate mathematics in a variety of forms.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

38/53

Mathematics Extension 1 - HSC	A	B	C	D	E
Uses inductive reasoning in the construction of proofs		✓			
Uses the relationship between functions, inverse functions and their derivatives	✓				
Determines integrals by reduction to a standard form through a given substitution			✓		
Evaluates mathematical solutions to problems and communicates them in an appropriate form			✓		

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is a diligent student who works quietly, independently and without fuss. She has demonstrated an outstanding level of understanding in Mathematics and a high level of knowledge in Mathematics Extension 1. Across the two courses, Anna has displayed strength across all Mathematics outcomes as well as when using the relationship between functions and their derivatives. She would benefit from consolidating her knowledge of evaluating and communicating mathematical solutions to problems. Anna can find improvement in these courses through revision of Preliminary content, improved structure of solutions, asking more questions in class, setting up a consistent study program and seeking out alternative question styles.

Teacher: Mr D Jones

Class: 12MATX17Bb



Physics Stage 6

During this semester students developed their understanding of complex motion by analysing the forces acting on a system and the associated energy transformations. By applying mathematical techniques, students modeled and predicted projectile motion and uniform circular motion. They also examined the observations that led to our current understanding of the nature of light, the development of quantum theory and the theory of relativity. Students explored the evidence supporting these physical theories and the power of scientific theories have to make predictions.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

12/38

Physics Stage 6	A	B	C	D	E
Develops, designs and evaluates questions, hypotheses and scientific investigations in order to obtain primary and secondary data and information		✓			
Selects, processes, analyses and evaluates appropriate qualitative and quantitative information using a range of primary and secondary data	✓				
Communicates scientific understanding using suitable language and terminology for a specific audience or purpose	✓				
Describes and analyses evidence for the properties of light and evaluates the implications of this evidence for modern theories of physics in the contemporary world		✓			

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is an affable and industrious student who demonstrates a positive approach to Physics. She demonstrates the ability in class to achieve at a higher level that is evident in her assessment results. Anna should focus on the application and communication of her knowledge and understanding to ensure that she can articulate responses that are complete, concise and logical in the appropriate context. Her depth study on the development of our understanding of what light is showed an amazing ability to deconstruct a complex concept and communicate it effectively to an authentic audience. To further improve her results Anna needs to engage in a systematic program of revision to further expand to consolidate her understanding. She should also complete practice problems to determine if she can apply and communicate her understanding to the depth required by the Physics syllabus. This will identify any areas of weakness that Anna should focus on to be more successful in her HSC.

Teacher: Mr A Smith

Class: 12PHY4A



Software Design and Development - HSC

Students in this course practised analysing problems and designed solutions involving algorithms. They studied standard algorithms for processing linear and multi-dimensional arrays, records and files and implemented methodologies to check the correctness of an algorithm. Students used system modelling tools to represent computerised systems and as an aid to developing software solutions. They investigated the importance of quality assurance for software development and explored issues involving software copyright.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

1/7

Software Design and Development - HSC	A	B	C	D	E
Knowledge and understanding about how software solutions utilise and interact with other elements of computer systems	✓				
Knowledge and understanding of legal, social and ethical issues and their effect on software design and development	✓				
Skills in designing and developing software solutions	✓				
Skills in management appropriate to the design and development of software solutions	✓				
Skills in teamwork and communication associated with the design and development of software solutions	✓				

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is a quiet achiever who has worked consistently during the semester, demonstrating an outstanding understanding of the topics studied. She has set herself a challenging programming task for her major project and is demonstrating great persistence and resilience to work through a variety of issues. Anna should maintain a focus on the theoretical aspects of the course and her second assessment task indicates that further review of data flow diagrams and pseudocode could further enhance her results.

Teacher: Mr J Taylor

Class: 12SDD5A



Japanese Continuers - HSC

The study of Japanese contributes to the overall education of students, particularly in the areas of communication, cross-cultural understanding, literacy and general knowledge. It promotes understanding of different attitudes and values within the wider Australian community and beyond and will better equip students as travellers and provide access to a significant part of the culture, traditions and attitudes of Japanese-speaking communities. In the HSC course, students focus on three prescribed themes that are the individual, the Japanese speaking communities and the changing world. Students will also study associated topics and draw on a range of tasks and text types to gain a broader understanding of the Japanese language and culture while extending and refining their communication skills in the language.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

7/9

Japanese Continuers - HSC	A	B	C	D	E
Exchange information, opinions and experiences in Japanese		✓			
Express ideas through the production of original texts in Japanese		✓			
Analyse, process and respond to texts that are in Japanese			✓		
Understand aspects of the language and culture of Japanese-speaking communities		✓			

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills		✓	
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner		✓	
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is a capable language student who continues to apply herself diligently in all class activities. She is capable of producing a high standard of written texts, however, she would benefit from regular speaking and writing practice to ensure a range of grammatical structures are constantly applied accurately in varied contexts. Thorough preparation such as submitting the drafts for speaking, writing compositions and obtaining feedback will help Anna improve her confidence in producing texts. Additionally, regular revision on kanji and vocabulary will advantage her in all four skill areas.

Teacher: Ms M MATSUI

Class: 12JAP6A



English Advanced Stage 6

This semester students have covered the common module: Texts and Human Experiences which explores how texts represent individual and collective human experiences in relation to human qualities and emotions associated with, or arising from, these experiences. Students have engaged critically and creatively through a close study of the novel 'All the Light We Cannot See' by Anthony Doerr and texts of their own choosing. Students have also engaged in Module C: The Craft of Writing where they have appreciated, analysed and evaluated the versatility, power and aesthetics of language in quality texts in order to experiment with their writing for a range of audiences and purposes using language to convey ideas and emotions with power and precision.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

69/114

English Advanced Stage 6	A	B	C	D	E
Uses, evaluates and justifies processes, skills and knowledge required to effectively respond to and compose texts in different modes, media and technologies		✓			
Critically analyses and uses language forms, features and structures of texts justifying appropriateness for specific purposes, audiences and contexts and evaluates their effects on meaning		✓			
Thinks imaginatively, creatively, interpretively, critically and discerningly to respond to, evaluate and compose texts that synthesise complex information, ideas and arguments	✓				
Evaluates the diverse ways texts can represent personal and public worlds and recognises how they are valued		✓			
Reflects on, evaluates and monitors own learning and refines individual and collaborative processes as an independent learner		✓			

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is a quiet yet perceptive student who has achieved some pleasing results in English Advanced. She can evaluate texts in relation to the module concepts and to improve her critical responses she needs to provide more detailed analysis of language forms and feature in relation to task requirements. Anna makes discerning conceptual and language choices with her creative compositions and further experimentation with expression of intricate ideas and reflection on authorial purpose will be of benefit. Anna is encouraged to maintain diligent organisation and refine her study notes for each module as she proceeds throughout the remainder of the HSC course.

Teacher: Ms C Tolland

Class: 12ENG3E



Modern History Stage 6

Year 12 Modern History have completed the Core Study (Power and Authority in the Modern World 1919-1946) and the National Study (Russia and the Soviet Union 1917-1941). The Core study focuses on the developments of the modern world, the complexities associated with the changing nature of sources, their expanding quantity, range and form, and the distinctive characteristics of modern historical representation. The National Study investigate key features, individuals, groups, events and developments that shaped the history of Russia during a specific period of the 20th century.

Cumulative Assessment Rank

9/23

Modern History Stage 6	A	B	C	D	E
Accounts for the nature of continuity and change in the modern world	✓				
Proposes arguments about the varying causes and effects of events and developments		✓			
Evaluates the role of historical features, individuals, groups and ideas in shaping the past	✓				
Analyses the different perspectives of individuals and groups in their historical context	✓				
Assesses the significance of historical features, people, ideas, movements, events and developments of the modern world	✓				

Area	C	U	S
Demonstrates effective organisational skills	✓		
Exhibits a positive attitude toward others	✓		
Cooperatively participates in class activities	✓		
Shows initiative as an independent learner	✓		
Uses feedback to develop learning goals	✓		

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Teacher Comment

Anna is a talented young lady who consistently exhibits a phenomenal understanding of Modern History and the concepts and ideologies embedded within it. Her ability to apply extensive and accurate information to synthesise her arguments reflects a pleasing maturity in her writing. Anna's extended response for Russia demonstrated comprehensive detail supported through the integration of examples and historians to support her argument. She needs to ensure she is consistently succinct in the structure of her extended responses to support the sophisticated flair of her language. Anna's natural desire to succeed combined with her proactive work ethic should see her continue on her journey to achieving an outstanding HSC result.

Teacher: Mrs A Heka

Class: 12MH2A